

One test set, three linkage procedures

Each procedure receives the same six observed fields for the same 225 pairs.

Compare frozen decisions
with reference identities

**Shared observed
records**

15 records per table
**225 candidate
pairs**

Supervised Splink

Known matching training pairs
Validation threshold: **26%**

10 true links found

0 false links
0 true links missed
215 correct rejections

Splink with EM

No fitting or validation labels
Fixed threshold: **50%**

10 true links found

0 false links
0 true links missed
215 correct rejections

LOTUS + GPT-6 Luna

No task-specific fitting labels
Fixed zero-shot instruction

8 true links found

0 false links
2 true links missed
215 correct rejections

EM prior: strict matching rules with assumed 80% rule recall. No reference identities enter this estimate.

Evaluation: reference identities identify 10 true links and 215 nonmatches. These labels measure errors.

Recorded configurations on 6 October 2026: Splink 5.0.0; LOTUS 1.2.4 with gpt-6-luna.